

Presentation Skills



Presentation

A presentation:

- has an introduction, body and conclusion

- may include visual aids

- is usually followed by questions and discussions

- may also have a handout for the audience to

take away.

Introduction

The introduction should orient the audience to your subject and purpose. To capture interest and set up rapport, it should tell the audience what to expect.

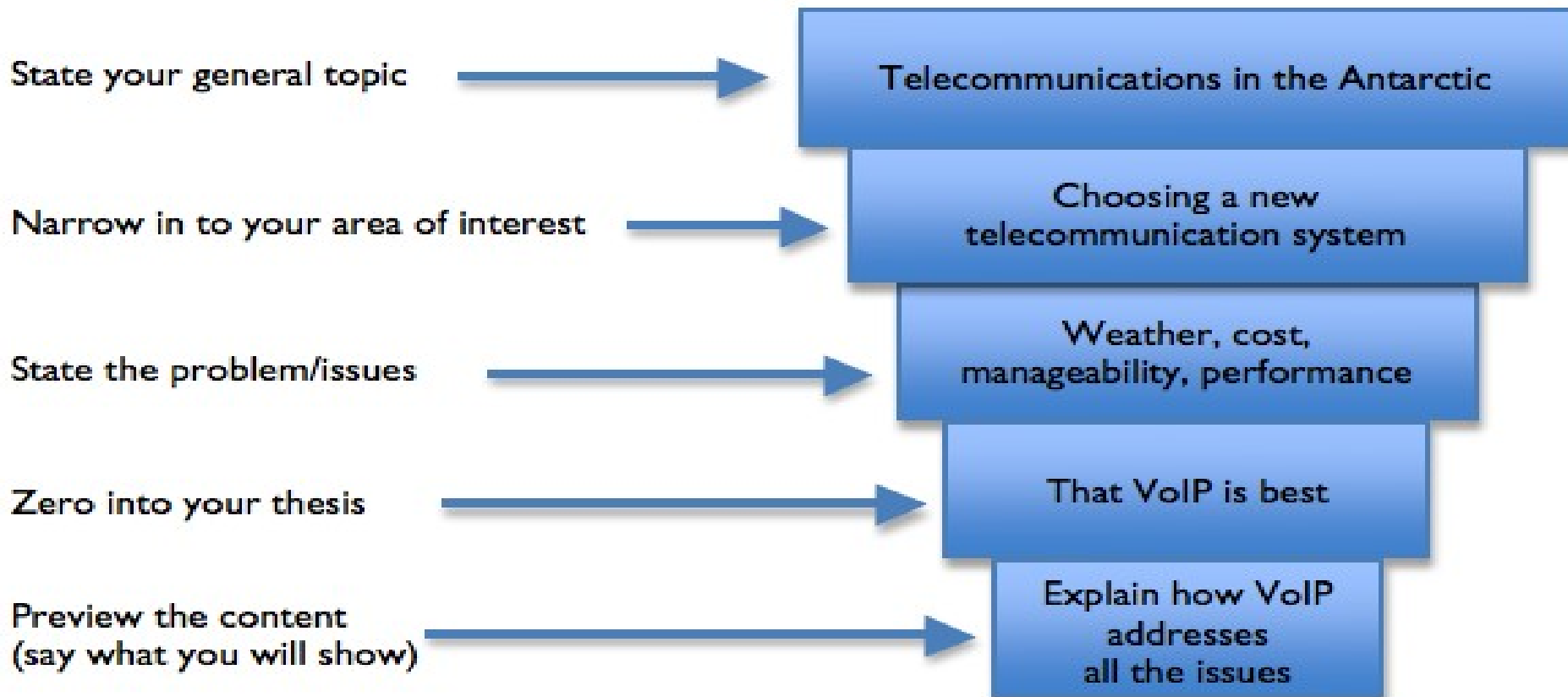
Be sure to carefully define the central point (or thesis) that is the basis of your talk and ensure that your supporting argument or information relates closely to it.

If you are not proceeding from an already written assignment, it might help to think of your introduction as funnel-shaped, with the content coming out of the funnel.

Diagram

INTRODUCTION

The introduction should narrow down from a broad topic to the specifics of your talk.



Etiquette and Language for Presentation

Greet an Audience	Good morning/afternoon distinguished guests/ladies and gentlemen/colleagues (whichever is appropriate)
• Express special acknowledgements if appropriate	• I'd especially like to welcome... I'd like to thank...
• Signal question/discussion opportunity	• There will be time for questions and discussion at the end of my talk. If you have questions, please feel free to interrupt.
Explain the topic area and purpose	This presentation will cover mainly... I am going to show that... I will argue that...
Dispose of a distraction or side issue	Before I start, let me clarify one point... My discussion will not cover...
Briefly preview the organisation of the body of your talk	The main points I will make are, first... second... and third... The subject can be examined under the following headings... We can divide this area into a number of fields. They are...

Body of the Presentation

The structure of the presentation is crucial.

Whether you organise:

chronologically,
by priority,
or theme

Staging the Body of Your Presentation

Begin the body of the talk	The first point I would like to address is... Let me first raise...
Develop the first point	For example... This is especially important because...
Sum up the first point	So, we can see that...
Introduce the second point	Secondly, I'd like to turn to...
Develop the second point	An important statistic in this area is... It means that...
Sum up the second point	It's evident that...
Bring in the final point	Finally, we need to look at...
Develop the final point	This situation exists because... It's worth noting that...
Sum up the body of the talk and remind listeners of the topic	To summarise... To review, we have found that... What I have been saying is that...

Conclusion

The conclusion again states your main points and what has been learned or shown but you also may raise implications inherent in the findings and offer creative recommendations.

Staging the Conclusion

Signal the end of your talk is coming Remind the audience again of the topic	In conclusion, we have examined the question that...
Remind the audience of your argument	We discussed...
Remind the audience of your findings	The evidence shows that...
Alert the audience that you have thought deeply about the topic	An important implication is...
Offer an innovative, provoking thought to take away	I would like to offer recommendations to address this. Firstly... Secondly...
Signal the end of your talk	Thank you for your time and attention today.
Signal the question/discussion session	I'd now like to open the floor for questions and discussion.

Handling Questions

- Let the audience know when to ask questions (during your talk? at the end?).
- Open the Q&A using an open question format (Who has the first question? or What topic should we begin discussing?) rather than a “yes/no” question (Are there any questions?) Offer a discussion point if the audience is slow to participate.
- Listen carefully to the entire question.
- Repeat the question aloud to clarify the question and enable the audience to hear it.
- Stop and think about your response.
- Answer briefly and coherently.
- It's much better to say “I don't know” than to make up an inaccurate or misleading answer.
- Respond to difficult people calmly and politely; help them feel heard by briefly acknowledging their concern / point / question, and then offer to follow up with them after the question period is over.
- Thank your audience for their participation.

Presentation Skills Checklist

Delivery

- The speaker **greeted** the audience warmly.
- I could **hear** the speaker.
- I could **understand** the speaker.
- The talk was delivered with **warmth and conviction**.
- The presentation seemed **practiced**.
- The speaker **involved the audience**.
- The talk included **effective examples** and illustrations.
- The speaker responded to **questions** and comments effectively and with calm courtesy.
- The speaker defined technical **terms** as needed.

Content

- The opening got my **attention**.
- The introduction **told us what to expect** from the presentation.
- The purpose of the talk was **clear**.
- The talk's structure was **logical**.
- The presentation was **well-suited to the audience**.

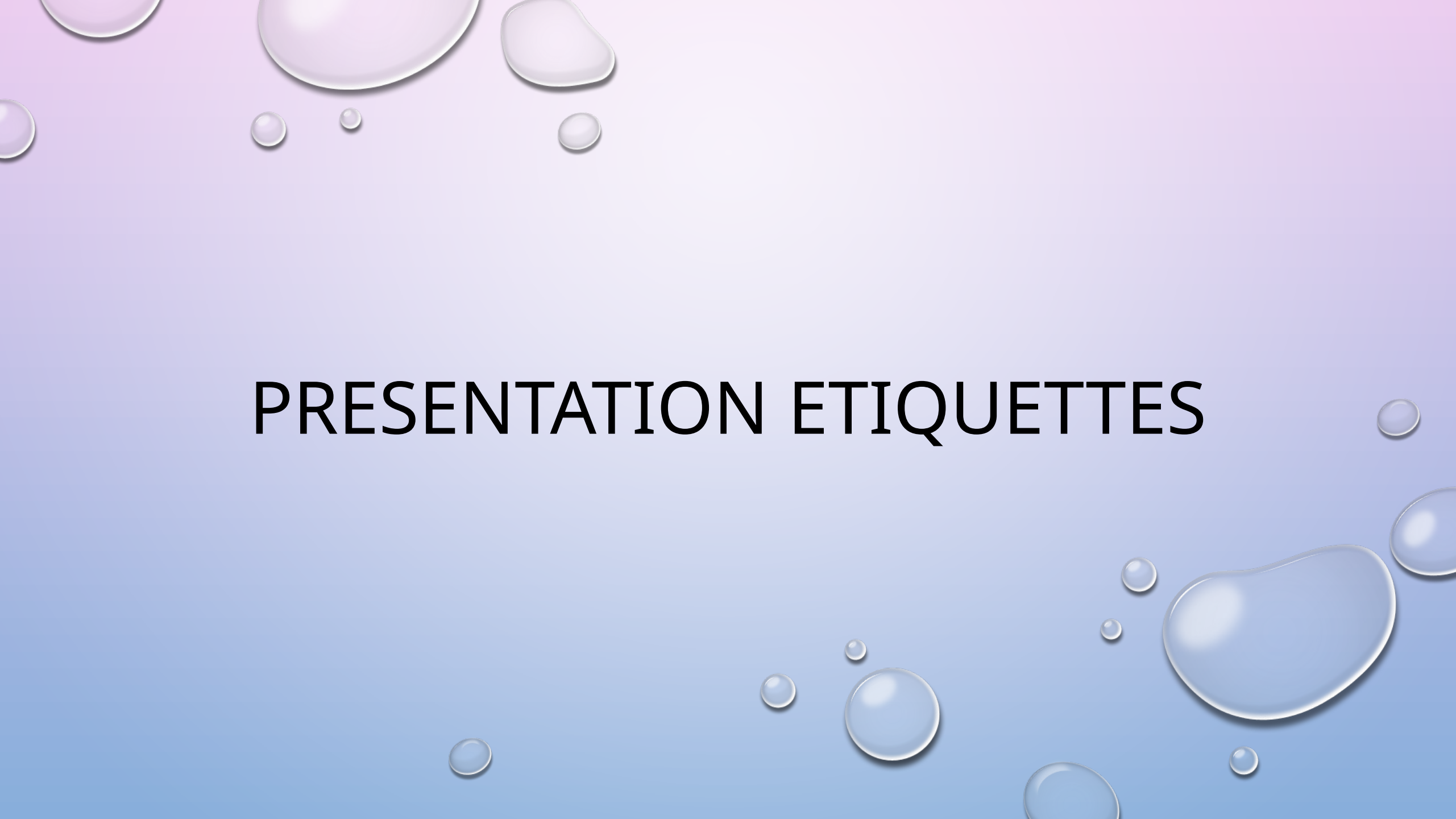
Cont.....

Body language

- The speaker showed **enthusiasm**.
- The speaker had **good eye contact** with the audience.
- The speaker showed no **distracting** movements or gestures.
- The speaker **smiled**.
- The speaker used **gestures** to help communicate ideas visually.

Visual aids

- The speaker used accessible and inclusive **visual aids**.
- I **could read** the material from where I was sitting.
- The visual aids got the point across in **a clear and simple way**.
- The speaker **did not block the screen** or flip chart.
- The speaker **talked to the audience** rather than to the screen or flip chart.

The background is a smooth gradient from light purple at the top to light blue at the bottom. Scattered across the background are numerous water droplets of various sizes. Some droplets are in the top left corner, others in the bottom right, and a few are smaller and more isolated. Each droplet has a realistic 3D appearance with highlights and shadows.

PRESENTATION ETIQUETTES

1. Arrive Early and Prepared

- You should arrive about an hour before you deliver your presentation.
- This may seem like an extreme amount of time, but it's not.
- There is parking to consider, finding the presentation location, equipment set-up and testing, etc.
- You also need to be prepared.
- Showing up early can ensure your preparedness.
- You have the time to triple check that everything works and you have what you need. If all this becomes unnecessary, at least you are there early enough to improvise.

2. Dress Properly and Eat Well

- The way you dress will reflect not only you, but everything you are representing.
- Dress for the event, but don't over do it.
- Consider your audience and the purpose of the presentation to best select your dress code.
- Eating well is two-sided. You need to maintain your energy supply

3) Don't Be Too Quick To React

- Fast reaction seems like you are on the defensive side.
- Allow a brief second for questions or reactions from the audience to set in. There is magic in a pause. A brief 3 second pause is never noticed by your audience and it gives you time to breathe, think, and react.
- Reacting too fast can cause fillers, like ums and ahs, or make you seem rash.

4) Own Your Stage and Watch Your Body Language

- Sticking to one spot makes you look stiff.
- If you look stiff, everything you are representing is stiff. Own your stage.

This goes back to arriving early and having time to know the space you have to work with.

- Move around it so you can address every part of the room. The body language you use on the stage also aids in conveying your message.
- Every movement should have a specific purpose. Don't just move for the sake of moving.

5. Be Prepared for the Unexpected

- Unless you have psychic abilities and can see into the future, you don't know when the unexpected is coming.
- You can, however, be prepared for the worst case scenarios.
- Know your material in case there is a problem where you can't use your visual aid.
- Maybe you were going to present to a small group and now it is an entire auditorium, what do you do?
- Relax and present to the individuals.
- Make sure you can work without your primary presentation file if required
 - even your backup files should have backup files.

6. Never Turn Your Back on the Audience

- This is seen as disrespectful by many.
- It should be a general “best practice” rule to always keep your shoulders forward.
- Reading from your visual aid can kill your authority with the audience.
- Besides, the audience is investing their time into your presentation, so don't turn your back on them.
- In the case of an online presentation when you're broadcasting yourself across the web, stay in front of your camera.
- If you're not using your camera but instead just screen sharing to present your presentation content, never step away from the mic.

7. Speak with an Educative Tone

- The purpose of delivering your presentation is to educate the audience on your topic. They don't know what you know. They don't want to know everything you know either.
- Keep it concise but explain any jargon you use.
- When delivering your presentation you should do so with the assumption that this is the first time they have heard any of your material. The result is better engagement with your audience.

8. Be Respectful and Thoughtful

- Know your manners: 'Please.' 'Thank You.'
- Wait for other's to complete a thought. You also need to understand that their time is valuable.
- Some members of your audience may feel you're wasting their time before you get started.
- Respect their time and make sure that in exchange for the time they give you, that you are providing constant value throughout your presentation.

9. Be Aware of Your Word Emphasis

- The way you add emphasis to your words convey meaning.
- Excitement in your voice is great, but emphasizing certain words changes the whole meaning of your sentence.
- Like “Does SHE have to come with us” versus “Does she have to come with us” sends a different message.
- In the first example it seems like the speaker has some dislike for the person in question. The second one is a simply stated question. You can’t really tell if there is added meaning to the statement. Be aware of how you emphasize words.

Logical fallacies refer to errors in an author's reasoning and therefore writing that makes the overall argument less believable or credible for the reader. Essentially, logical fallacies impair the communication of the author's ideas, leading to a less convincing argument by weakening the presentation of the author's logic.

In writing, logic refers to a pattern of explicating the relationship and connections between an author's claim, evidence, and conclusions. Logical writing contains clearly described claims, evidence that proves these claims, and conclusions that explain the validity and significance of the overall argument.

Strawman Fallacy (Misrepresenting an argument, attacking the argument, and then concluding that the argument has been proven wrong)

This fallacy involves intentionally caricaturing a person's argument to attack the caricature rather than the actual argument. This fallacy comes into play when someone misrepresents, misquotes, misconstrues, and oversimplifies an opponent's argument. A straw man argument is usually one that is more absurd than the actual argument. By doing this, the speaker makes the opponent's argument an easier target to attack and might convince a person to defend the ridiculous argument rather than their original one.

Example:

- 1) Any politician who does not support the proposed state minimum wage increase hates the poor!
- 2) I think we should spend less on the military.

Hasty Generalization (Basing the goodness of a rule on only a few cases.)

This fallacy happens when someone sets a conclusion based on inadequate evidence. Writers must state their conclusions only after researching all relevant facts to avoid committing this fallacy.

Examples:

- 1) Even though I just started this new job, I am going to start looking for a new job because this one is too hard."

Appeal to Authority (Claiming something to be true because an expert said so)

When writers or speakers use **appeal to authority**, they are claiming that something must be true because it is believed by someone who said to be an "authority" on the subject. Whether the person is actually an authority or not, the logic is unsound. Instead of presenting actual evidence, the argument just relies on the credibility of the "authority."

Example:

- 1) Someone argues that drinking is morally wrong and cites a sermon from her pastor at church

Ad Hominem (Directly attacking another person, his or her character)

An argument that attempts to disprove the truth of what is asserted by attacking the speaker rather than the speaker's argument. Another way of putting it: Fallacy where you attack someone's character instead of dealing with salient issues.

Example: Johnson (2006) does not have a PhD in nuclear physics, so his argument must be incorrect."

Post HOC (Arguing that simply because an event occurred earlier instantly suggests that it caused another event.)

An argument from a premise of the form "A preceded B" to a conclusion of the form "A caused B." Simply because one event precedes another event in time does not mean that the first event is the cause of the second event.

Example: Many people who enjoy a diet high in cholesterol eventually develop high blood cholesterol; clearly, high dietary cholesterol causes high blood cholesterol.

Ad Populam (Appealing to emotions and enthusiasm rather than relevant facts)

The fallacy is the **appeal to common belief** or **appeal to the masses** because it's all about getting people to do or think something because "everyone else is doing it" or "everything else thinks this."

Either/or :

The writer tries to convince the reader that there are only two sides to an issue--one right, one wrong. The reader is led to believe that the issue has no other viewpoints.

EXAMPLES: Love America or leave it.

Appeal to Pity:

An appeal to pity fallacy is committed when the arguer attempts to influence the listener not by providing good reasons for the conclusion, but by mentioning sad or difficult circumstances that are irrelevant to the issue.

Examples:

- 1) He embezzled a million dollars, but his wife had just died and his child needed surgery.

ENG 1002 CAT 2 STUDY MATERIAL

Sample Letter

Use this sample letter to write a complaint about a product or service.

Your Address

Your City, State, Zip Code

[Your email address, if sending by email]

Date

Name of Contact Person [if available] **Title** [if available] **Company Name**
Consumer Complaint Division [if you have no specific contact] **Street Address**
City, State, ZIP Code

Sub: **[Brief, in a sentence]**

Dear **[Contact Person or Consumer Complaint Division]**:

On **[date]**, I **[bought, leased, rented, or had repaired/serviced]** a **[name of the product, with serial or model number or service performed]** at **[location and other important details of the transaction]**.

Unfortunately, **[your product has not performed well (or) the service was inadequate]** because **[state the problem, like the product doesn't work properly, the service wasn't performed correctly, I was billed the wrong amount, or something was not disclosed clearly or was misrepresented, etc.]**.

To resolve the problem, I would appreciate a **[state the action you want, like a refund, store credit, repair, exchange, etc.]**. Enclosed are copies **[do not send originals]** of my records **[include receipts, guarantees, warranties, canceled checks, contracts, model and serial numbers, and any other documents]** concerning this purchase **[or repair]**.

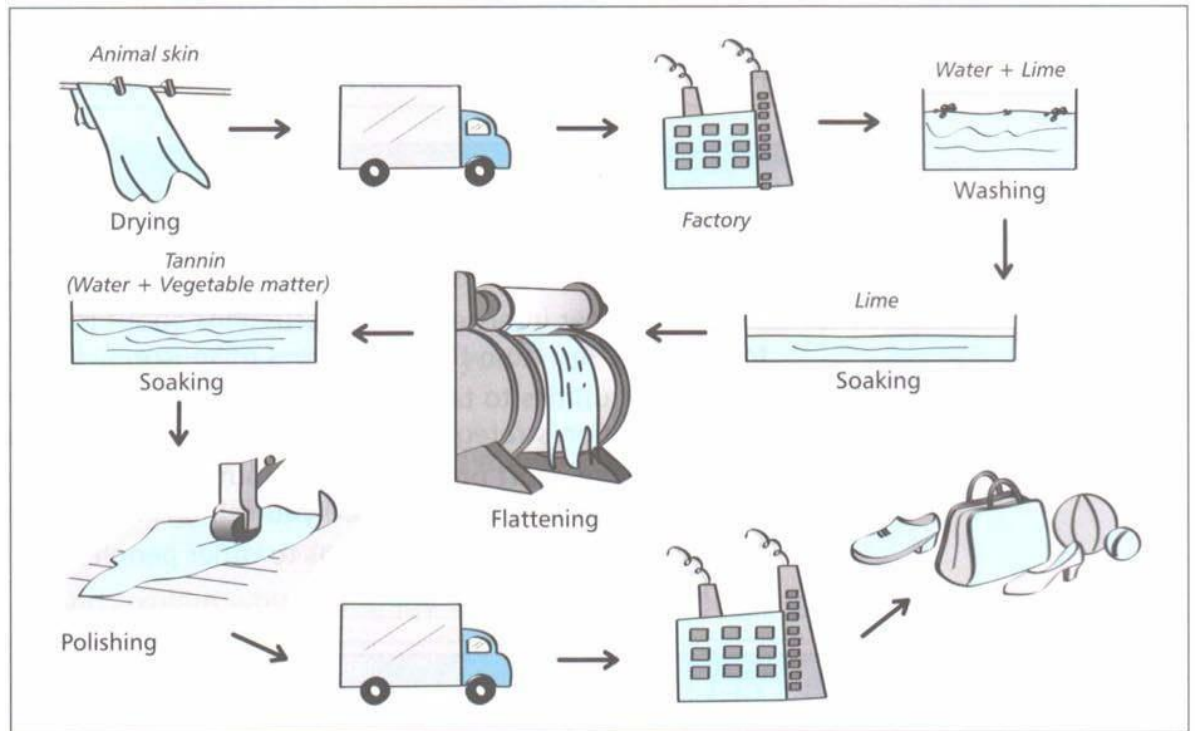
I look forward to your reply and a resolution to my problem. I will wait until **[set a reasonable time limit]** before seeking help from a consumer protection agency or other assistance. Please contact me at the above address or by phone at **[phone number with area code]**.

Sincerely,

Your Signature

Your name

Process Description example:



Process Description: First, the animal skin is dried (dry) under the heat of the sun by hanging it on a rope. After that, they are transferred (transfer) to a factory on trucks. After this, the animal skins are washed (wash) with a mixture of water and lime. Then, the skins are soaked (soak) in limewater for some more time. In the next step, the animal skin is flattened (flatten) in a rolling machine. ...

Use present tense (is/are) and the third form of the verb given in the brackets to fill in the blanks.

Memorandum (Memo)

Format (Draw a box and write the memo within the box)

Memorandum

To: [Include recipients' name]

From: [Include your name and title]

Date: [Day Month year]

Subject: [Subject of the memo]

[A memo requires no salutation]

Body of the memo

[Start with a direct and brief introduction that states the reason for writing the memo.]

[Provide concise but detailed information to the reader.]

[End with a clear closing and a call-to-action.]

Sample Memo:

To: Loading Dock Staff

From: Philip Yuen, Director of Shipping

Date: June 30, 2017

Subject: Update to Shipping Procedures

Due to some recent shipping issues, the Board has decided to update part of our shipping procedure. Whenever an order is ready to ship, please leave that order's shipping form in my office mailbox, and I'll return it to your station once I confirm everything is correct. Although this change will slow down our process a little, it will hopefully prevent further errors.

If you have any questions, please feel welcome to stop by my office. Thank you all for everything you do. Your hard work is appreciated.

User Manual Instructions:

You will be given instructions with any of these below mentioned four errors. Identify them and write the correct instruction.

1. Use of modal verbs

Modal verbs like *must, shall, will, should, would, can, could, may, and might* are not used in user manual instructions.

Example: You **should** wear the safety gloves before you open the device.

Error: use of the modal verb should.

Correct instruction: Wear the safety gloves before you open the device.

2. Use of polite language

Polite forms of expression like please, kindly are not used in user manual instructions.

Example: **Please** charge the torch light before you use it.

Error: use of polite language

Correct instruction: Charge the torch light before you use it.

3. Use of passive form

Avoid passive voice and use only active voice in user manual instructions.

Example: The torch light **is to be charged** before using it.

Error: passive construction of sentence

Correct instruction: Charge the torch light before you use it.

4. Sentence sequencing error

Avoid sequence error and write the instructions in proper order.

Example: Serve the curry along with rice and allow the curry to boil for ten minutes.

Error: sequencing error

Correct instruction: Allow the curry to boil for ten minutes and serve the curry/it along with rice.

Product Definition:

You will be given images of four products along with parts and functions marked against them. Write the sentence definition for each product along with the description using the given methods. Follow the word limit given in the question paper.

Sentence definition of a product:

A sentence definition usually follows a standard pattern: the item to be defined is

placed in a category of similar items and then distinguished from them.

Example: “In this report, electron microscope refers to any microscope that uses electrons rather than visible light to produce magnified images.”

Comparison and Contrast: Using comparison and contrast, a writer discusses the similarities or differences between the item being defined and an item with which readers are more familiar.

Partition Partitioning is the process of dividing a thing or an idea into smaller parts so that readers can understand it more easily.